

Official Curtis Riggleman

THE FIRST FIVE: ON BOARD SALES TRAINING

BOOK THREE

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Curtis Riggleman



The First Five: On Board Sales Training

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www.officialcurtisriggleman.com

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THE FIRST FIVE: ON BOARD SALES TRAINING

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Curtis Riggleman

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Introduction

WHAT YOU WILL LEARN IN THIS BOOK:

- The ten step sales process
- How to set up a training schedule
- The three customer conversations
- How to role play the customer conversations
- How to use the ABCD credit chart
- How to create social media ads
- How, when, and why to turn
- How to set up the walk around
- Teaching new hires how to deal with objections
- What drives leaders

Once you learn the techniques in this book, you will be able to set up your salespeople for success from their first week of sales training. This onboarding process takes out the confusion and overwhelm that happens to many new hires. This system will reduce the employee turnover in your store.

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TRAINING SCHEDULE

The first week includes:

- Memorize steps to the sale
- Get familiar with the dealership
- Role playing the steps
- Write ups and close
- Learning the CRM and other apps.
- Stock in trade and trade ins
- Create social media ads

On the following pages, find a sample training schedule for the first week. Each day is structured to build skills. Role playing figures in heavily and is first in the schedule.

TRAINING SCHEDULE..DAY 1

The first day includes:

1. (45 min) Walk through dealership, departments, parking, trade-ins, conference room, etc. Meet & greet other employees.
2. (30 min) Memorize 10 steps to the sale
3. (30 min) Step 1~Attitude
4. (30-45 min) Role play Step 2~Meet & Greet

Lunch break

5. (2 hours) Role play Step 3~Investigate and Step 4 Walk & Choose
6. (45 min) Role play Conversation #1
7. (45 min) Role play Step 6~Walk Around
8. Role play Steps 2 through 6.

TRAINING SCHEDULE..DAY 2

The second day includes:

1. (30 min) Show a test drive route~Step 6
2. (45 min) Role play Step 7~Conversation #2, communicate
3. (30 min) Role play Step 9~ Commit to come inside
4. (1 hour) Role play Step 10~ Write up & close

Lunch break

5. (1 hour) Role play Step 9~ Write up & close
6. (45 min) Role play Conversation #3
7. (2 hour) Role play After Sale: Delivery, social media pictures & reviews, stocking in trade & posting on Facebook Marketplace as fresh trade in.

TRAINING SCHEDULE..DAY 3

The third day includes:

1. (1 hour) Role play: Steps 2& 3
2. (1 hour) Role play: Step 6~Walk around with value
3. (1 hour) Role play: Ways to separate yourself and your store from the competition
4. (30 min) Role play~ Practice all three role plays from the morning.

Lunch break

5. (1 hour) Role Play: How, when, and why to turn
6. (2 hour) Role play Step 10~ Write up & Close
7. Finish the day with recap on the day's activities

TRAINING SCHEDULE..DAY 4

The fourth day includes:

1. (1hour) Learn how to use the CRM
2. (1 hour) Learn how to use V Auto, down load app, and do trade inspection.
3. (1 hour) Learn basic new inventory features
4. (30 min) Learn stock in trades, and put away in trade area

Lunch break

5. (1 -2 hours) Role play basic outside objections
6. (1 hour) Create Facebook and social media ads
7. Recap this day's training activities

TRAINING SCHEDULE..DAY 5

The fifth day includes:

1. Attend sales rally
2. (2-3 hours) Full run through of Steps & after sale activities

Lunch break

3. (1 hour) Full run through of the steps & after sale activities
4. Touch on any area needing help
5. Fill out & sign training check list
6. Turn list into HR to be included in employee's file



Notes:

This image shows a single sheet of white paper with horizontal blue ruling lines. The lines are evenly spaced and run across the width of the page. There are no margins or other markings on the paper.

Ten Steps to The Sale

STEP BY STEP SHORTCUT

01. Attitude
02. Meet and greet
03. Investigate
04. Walk & choose
05. Display
06. Walk around~sell the vehicle
07. Demo
08. Communicate (build rapport)
09. Commitment to come inside
10. Write up and close

After sale: Post pictures and/or video to your social media. Post reviews. Post trade in and stock in trade to FB marketplace.

STEP ONE: ATTITUDE

Attitude is step one because it overrides everything else. You can do everything right with a bad attitude and not sell anything, or everything wrong with a great attitude and sell cars. When you pair the right attitude with the right skills, now you are really winning.

Attitude isn't just being positive, it is having a winning attitude, an attitude of gratitude, and a “bullet proof” attitude that no matter what is thrown at you, you are a WINNER, here to WIN.

When you think like a winner, you put off a vibe, and you win more.

Focus on what you can control: your attitude. Don't spend time talking about things you have no control over.

Be generous. When you help enough people get what they want, you'll get what you want in return.

Have a win or learn attitude. There are no losses, just lessons.

STEP TWO: POWER MEET & GREET

This starts before you even say “Hello”. Customers are making decisions about you at first sight, assessing whether you seem confident, whether you are well dressed and groomed, or do you look lazy?

Be aware that customers have negative thoughts about salespeople. They have a preconceived idea about you before they even meet you. They may have had bad experiences in the past. Your job is to WOW them and change their view of you at “Hello”.

Never do the lazy meet & greet (can I help you?) or (do you need any help?). Walk up to your customer, stand tall and confident, letting them know that they are working with a profes-

EXAMPLE: POWER MEET & GREET

Sales: Hello! Welcome to ABC Motors. My name is Curtis. And you are? (shake hands)

Customer: My name is Tom

EXAMPLE: POWER MEET & GREET

Sales: Great to meet you! First I want to thank you for giving me the opportunity to work for you. My goal today is to provide world class service. Before we get started, can I get you a cold water or some coffee?

Customer: No thank you.

Sales: Okay. Do you want to look at our new or preowned vehicles? Or have you already picked one out?

Customer: Actually, we saw this one online. Do you still have it?

Sales: I do. Come with me.

Always introduce yourself to everyone before moving forward. Give big smiles, be excited, and happy to help.

STEP THREE: INVESTIGATE

Fact finding accomplishes two things: You are finding their hot buttons and removing the ways they will try to use them to derail the sale. These are your tools for closing.

There are two types of customers: The most common type are people who have done some research and know what they want, or at least have a good idea of what they want.

The second type of customer is one who hasn't done research and wants to see what you have

EXAMPLE #1:

CUSTOMERS THAT HAVE DONE RESEARCH AND KNOW WHAT THEY WANT (THE 80%):

Sales: So who's the lucky on getting a new car? (Bob) Ok. Great! Congratulations! How long have you been thinking of getting a new car? (a year) That's awesome! What is it about this one that jumped out to you?

Customer: We like the color, and it's the right size for our family.

Sales: (**Repeat the hot buttons.** It shows that you are listening, and sets you up nicely for the next question: budgeting) So, if I'm hearing you correctly, you like the color and the size. Is that right?

Customer: Yes

Sales: Perfect. If this all works out today, what type of monthly budget do you have in mind?

KEY TAKEAWAYS:

- 1. You only have a small window of about 3 minutes from “Hello” to talking about the car.** You don’t want to waste any time talking about irrelevant information. Get to the point. What did we find out? By finding out who the car is for, we removed the issue of any missing party. By finding out what they liked about the car, you get the hot buttons that help you close with value, not price.
- 2. Repeat some of the hot buttons.** This not only shows that you are listening but it sets you up with leverage for budgeting.
- 3. When establishing budget, if you are within \$100 of where you should be, continue on with the process.** If you are miles off, then this is your opportunity to suggest something less expensive. Typically, customers don’t want to switch to a different car. What will probably happen is that you are helping them to realize and accept that the vehicle they want will cost more.

EXAMPLE FOR OFFERING A SWITCH FOR THE CUSTOMER WHOSE BUDGET DOESN'T MATCH WHAT HE CAME TO SEE:

Sales: Mr. Customer, can I throw you a curve ball?

Customer: Yes.

Sales: If I have a truck very similar to the one you want but it is 2 years older and 45K miles, priced at \$30K would you consider it? I think it would be perfect for your budget.

Customer: No, I want the Pro.

Sales: Ok. No problem. Let me get the keys.

Your customer now knows it's going to cost more than they had in mind. Your “bump” at the close is set up. Don't tell them that that their payment will be higher, because just that fast, you will be in a negotiation on the lot which you will likely lose. Plant the seed, and push the deal forward.

Notes:

[illegible]

EXAMPLE #2:

CUSTOMERS THAT WANT TO BROWSE/HAVEN'T DONE RESEARCH (THE 20%):

You still need hot buttons and closing tools, but will use a different set of questions.

When customers start looking without research, usually something happened to cause this. This is what I want to discover in my investigation.

EXAMPLE INVESTIGATION:

Customer: We are just getting started, not sure what we want. We just want to see what you have.

Sales: Ok. Great. Who's the lucky one getting a new car?

Customer: It's for me.

Sales: Ok. Congratulations! What made you decide to start looking now?

Customer: My transmission is acting up and I don't want to put money into it.

Sales: I see. Do you have any idea what you want to replace it with?

Customer: Not really, I'm open.

Sales: Ahh, I see. Well, let's start with what features your current car has that you want to keep for the next one.

Customer: Well, it has a leather interior and I like the way the back seat folds down for extra storage.

Sales: Ok. Great. What is your car missing or not doing for you? What do you want your next one to do?

Customer: I would like a leather interior. My kids messed up the back seat in mine. I don't want black this time. It's too hot.

Sales: Ok. Great. So if I'm hearing you correctly, we need a mid to full size car that gets great gas mileage, leather interior, and a lighter color. Is that right?

Customer: Exactly.

Sales: Awesome. If we find the perfect vehicle, what kind of monthly budget have you set aside for this?

Customer: I'm thinking \$350 to \$400.

Sales: I have the perfect vehicle. Come with me.

KEY TAKEAWAYS:

- **You need to be building an example in your mind** of the right vehicle for them with every question you ask.
- **Then, you need to make a suggestion.**
- **If your suggestion is not working, step back, and ask “What’s this one missing?”**
Then, show another one that will work. Don’t just keep showing random cars without getting more information from the customer.
- **You need to direct this customer** or they will leave more confused than when they came in....and still no deal.

When it comes to closing the deal, you have the hot points of car problems, saving money, and reliability.

STEP FOUR: WALK AND CHOOSE

When showing vehicles, always show the least expensive one that fits their needs. Let the customer upgrade if they so choose. Let them express their desire, that emotion will help you get the bump later in the close.

Even when they know what they want, if you have the opportunity, show something less expensive and let them decline it. This gives you leverage. For example, at the close, the customer wants a lower payment. Instead of lowering the payment, you offer to take a better look at the less expensive one. This technique alone is worth a \$50/month bump.

If the customer insists on a vehicle that you know is too much for their budget, do the “drive by” option. This works during the test drive, either on the way out of the dealership, or coming back in. For example, pull up a less expensive unit and tell the customer a couple of it’s benefits. Tell them that if for any reason the one we are currently test driving doesn’t work, keep this one in mind as a back up plan. This sets you up for later.

Once you have landed on what unit you are going to show them, pull the car out and isolate the vehicle away from the others.

STEP FIVE: DISPLAY

Displaying the vehicle is the point where customers start to take ownership~to visualize themselves owning this car. You may find that customers will try to stop you from pulling the vehicle out because they don't want to get emotionally attached. Don't get lazy here. Pull the vehicle out anyway. Use customer benefits if needed. For example: tell the customer that the last thing you want is to risk any door dings or scratches for him or the next customer. Tell him that you will get the keys and be right back. Be persistent here.

If it's hot outside, cool the car down. If it's cold, warm it up. Get the vehicle comfortable for the test drive. You are always setting the next step up in advance.

If you can, isolate the vehicle. If you have a nice area, perhaps with a shade tree, have your customer meet you there while you pull it over to them. This reduces the chance of them wondering off to another vehicle while you are

STEP SIX: WALK AROUND

Before you start your walk around, remember that customers research an average of 15 hours before coming to the lot. Most of the time they will believe what they read over what you say. You DON'T want to bring up new information that sends them back to the research stage, so don't sell the vehicle. Just confirm

EXAMPLE:

Sales: Mr. Customer, there are a lot of nice things about this unit, but I don't want to bore you with anything you are not interested in. What is it about this vehicle that you like? What else? Ok. Great, let me show you how that works.

Only go over a few items that they expressed interest in. Don't over sell. Just confirm that they are making the right decision. This process takes only 3 to 5 minutes.

Sell the store. Today's walk around is less about the car and more about why here, why you. Separate your store from the competition.

EXAMPLE:

Sales: Mr. Customer, let me tell you why more people in this area buy their cars right here. See that shop? We send every car there and whatever needs to be fixed, repaired, or replaced is done prior to being put on the lot. Only about half the cars we send there make it through our process. The ones that don't make it go back to the auction, and often end up on other lots, sometimes cheaper. We pride ourselves on making sure you get what you pay for. Let me go get the keys. I'll be right back.

You have established that everyone is doing it, so it must be the right thing. People want to conform socially, they want to fit in. We focus on quality, making sure the customer gets a good car. We acknowledge up front that we have seen cheaper cars, but cheaper doesn't mean better. This adds value to your asking price.

STEP SEVEN: DEMO

This step is where emotion kicks in. You must drive the car for a couple of reasons: (1) The feel of the wheel makes the deal. Once they drive it, they don't want to give it back. (2) Sometimes you work the whole deal, then drive it, and they don't like it or want things fixed. Now you no longer have wiggle room in the deal, and end up losing the deal.

Customers don't always want to test drive.

In order to avoid getting emotionally attached, they may say things like: "I don't need to drive it, all cars drive the same." OR "Let's work the payment first, then I will drive it." OR "I don't have time. Let's work the number first."

Use customer benefits to persuade them to do what you want while letting them make the decision. These techniques can be found in my book *Objections Aren't Real*.

When going on a test drive, have a plan. Pre-plan your route, have it mapped out. Control how the test drive goes. You don't want them picking the worst road or turn around after 50 feet and head back to the dealership. You drive out, then switch seats. Make this the best event, it's your top collateral for making a deal.

STEP EIGHT: BUILD RAPPORT DURING DEMO

The demo is the perfect time and place to start building rapport. You don't want to keep talking about the car~ it will feel like a salesman and customer. You want it comfortable, like two friends taking a test drive.

People love talking about themselves. Ask about what type of work they do, how long they have been at it, what made them decide to choose that work? Have other questions prepared that get people talking about themselves. Stay interested and keep a flow. This relaxes the customer, and helps the deal move forward and feel natural.

Before returning to the dealership, set up

STEP NINE: COMMIT TO COMING INSIDE

Setting everything up during the test drive keeps the process moving forward seamlessly. If you don't set this up in advance, there's a good chance they will get out of the car and ask for your card. No deal.

Persuade your customer to do what you want by using customer benefits, framing, and giving them a “way out”. They feel most

EXAMPLE OF THE SET UP:

Sales: So what do you think of the car?

Customer: I like it.

Sales: Ok. Great. I'll tell you what. When we get back, I'll show you what it takes to own it and you can tell me yes, no, or you want to think about it. I'm okay with any of the three. Fair enough?

Customer: That sounds good.

The customer heard that I will give them all the information and they can leave. This is what gets 100% of them to say yes to coming inside. **But they also agreed to come inside,** sit down, and let me go through my process, which is all I want right now. We put off the pressure of closing the deal until we are in the booth, and have the best odds of closing.

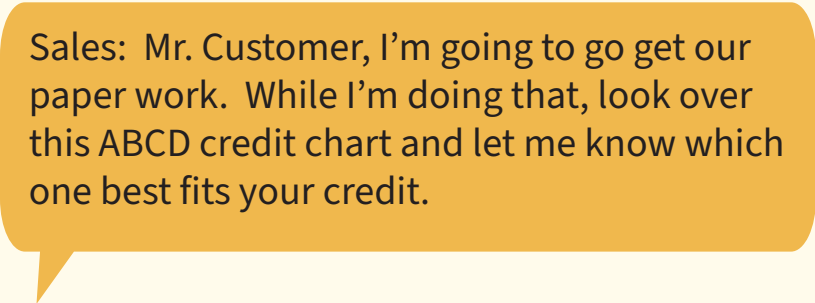
Customers that want a hard commitment on the lot could end up derailing a deal. Focus on getting to the next step and worry about closing the deal when you are inside the dealership. Again, use customer benefits, framing, and a way out to persuade them to come inside.

STEP TEN: WRITE UP AND CLOSE

When you come off the test drive, you are racing the clock. You want to get the first pencil in front of the customer as quickly as possible while they are still excited about the vehicle.

Step one: go straight inside. Sit down and start inputting their information into the system, your crm.

Step two: when ready to print, use the ABCD credit chart to set up your customer for the write up.



Sales: Mr. Customer, I'm going to go get our paper work. While I'm doing that, look over this ABCD credit chart and let me know which one best fits your credit.

This method sets up your write up and keeps the customer occupied while you are gone.

Step four: working your pencil. Start with the down payment suggested from the chart. 10/20/30 or 40 percent. For example, if the customer chooses option B, explain that the suggested down payment is 20%, but the more they put down, the lower the monthly payment will be. Then ask, “Were you thinking 20% or more?”

Once you get the customer’s counter to the down payment, then show the payment.

Use 20 to 25 for every 1000 borrowed. This doesn’t have to be exact, it’s an estimate. Speed is what is important here. If the customer says no, and wants to counter with a lower payment, then you can move back to down based on customer benefit.

EXAMPLE:

Sales: Mr. Customer, it may take that 20% to help get to the payment you had in mind. Could we get close to that 20% down to help us get to your payment?

Work the down payment a second time.

Show how how the new numbers would lower the payment, use that to get a payment bump.

Once you have worked the down payment and the payment twice, ask for commitment.

When asking for the commitment, you want to use a combination of hope and doubt; they are hopeful the offer will work, but at the same time have some doubt.

SAMPLE WRITE UP WITH "I WILL BUY NOW AT OFFER" COMMITMENT:

Date / /

29,900
+ Fees.

B-credit
20% down

#1-Sales \$6000-
#1-Cust \$2000-

#1-Sales 600-700
#1-Cust \$500

#2-Cust \$2500-

#2-Sales 590-690
#2-Cust \$550

I will buy Now @ offer

EXAMPLE OF PRESENTING THE “I WILL BUY NOW AT OFFER” COMMITMENT:

Sales: Mr. Customer, here's what I'm going to tell my boss: Keep in mind that this is just an offer, and it might not work. I promise you that no one will work harder for you than I will. Initial here, and I'll go to work.

Once they initial and you are ready to leave the booth, set up your bump.

Sales: Mr. Customer, I think we are close to the payment, but we may be off by 80 to 100 dollars. Wish me luck.

The goal of this technique is to give them time to discuss how much more they can pay while you are out of the office. By the time you walk back in, they have already decided how much more they are willing to go. Now all you need to do is ask for the bump.

*****In the following chapter, you can review the ABCD chart.

ABCD CREDIT CHARTS

During the write up process use the following charts to factor in to the deal. Each chart is factored with the customer's credit history as well as employment history. All are factors in determining a customer's character/behavior with regard to loans.

View a sample write up after the charts: Refer to page 40 for the sample write up.

ABCD CREDIT CHART

“A” CREDIT:

- 5 or more years at current address
- 5 or more years at current employer
- Previous auto loans are paid as agreed
- No bankruptcy in the past 10 years
- No repossessions, charged off accounts, or collections
- No collection accounts
- No more than (1) 30 day late payment in the past 5 years
- Suggested initial investment usually 10% or trade equity

ABCD CREDIT CHART

“B” CREDIT:

- Long term renter or over 1 year as home-owner
- Over 2 years with current employer
- Previous auto loans are paid as agreed
- Credit accounts paid as agreed.
- No bankruptcy in the last 10 years
- No repossessions or charged off accounts
- No more than 1 collection account, and not to exceed \$100
- No more than (3) 30 day or (1) 60 day late payments in the past 5 years.
- Suggested initial investment usually 20% cash or trade in equity.

ABCD CREDIT CHART

“C” CREDIT:

- Current renter for 1 or more years
- Over 6 months at current employer
- No bankruptcy in the past 7 years
- Charge off and collection accounts must be paid in full
- Some late payments, but all accounts must be current
- Suggested initial investment usually 30% cash or trade in equity

ABCD CREDIT CHART

“D” CREDIT:

- Verifiable home address
- Proof of previous address available
- 6 months or less with current employer
- Proof of previous employer available
- Dismissed bankruptcy for more than 1 year
- No derogatory credit since bankruptcy
- No more than (1) repossession of an auto with \$0.00 balance
- No more than (3) charged off accounts
- Suggested initial investment usually 40% cash or trade equity

Three Conversations

Every transaction will have three conversations:

1. Investigation
2. The test drive
3. Between pencils, and waiting on finance

You need to be prepared for these conversations, otherwise you won't collect the information you need in order to make the deal, and you will run out of things to talk about later, making it very uncomfortable.

CONVERSATION #1: Investigation

From meet & greet to landing on the vehicle, you only have about 5 minutes. This is the time to collect data to make your deal later. Don't talk about irrelevant subjects and waste this opportunity. Be a pro and get to the point.

This first conversation is a valuable 5 minutes. This is the only time the customer will give this information, while his guard is down.

EXAMPLE:

Sales: (Right after the meet & greet) So, who's the lucky one getting the new car? (**Establishes who the car is for. Eliminates a "third party" back door.**)

Customer: It's for me.

Sales: Well, congratulations! (Big smile!) how long have you been thinking of getting a new car? (**Removes "just started" back door.**)

Customer: We have been looking for a couple of weeks now.

Sales: Great! And what is it about this one that jumped out to you? (**Hot buttons**)

Customer: It's the exact color we have been looking for.

Sales: Ok. Is that the only thing?

Customer: Actually, this one has the engine we wanted and it's 4X4~ we have to have 4X4.

Sales: Ok. Great. It sounds like you found the right truck, why is the 4X4 so important?

Customer: We have a cabin in the hills and it snows in the winter. **(Leverage)**

Sales: Ah yes, ok. I guess that would be important. If this truck turns out to be the perfect one, what type of monthly budget have you set aside for this? **(Set up for budget)**

Customer: Somewhere between 500 and 600 per month. **(Budget)**

Sales: Ok. Perfect.

By now you are at the vehicle. What you have accomplished:

1. Learned who the vehicle is for (removing the “3rd party” back door).
2. Learned how long they’ve been looking (removing “just started” back door).
3. You have a list of hot buttons to build value and establish some leverage to close the deal later.

Notes:

CONVERSATION #2: The Test Drive

The most important thing to remember is that you want this to feel comfortable, like two friends taking a drive. You don't want it to feel like a sales rep and a customer going for a test drive. People love talking about themselves, so this is the perfect time to ask them questions.

EXAMPLE:

Sales: So, what type of work are you in?

Customer: I'm a teacher.

Sales: Really! That's great! Teachers don't get enough credit for their hard work. What made you want to be a teacher?

Customer: I don't know. I just like working with kids.

Sales: How long have you been a teacher? (etc. Just keep the conversation going. Make it feel natural and stay interested.

The goal is to make them comfortable with you. They already decided they want the truck, if they want to buy from you is the only question left.

CONVERSATION #3: Between Pencil & Waiting on Finance

Don't get caught in the common trap of running out of things to talk about. You want to keep the customer focused on visualizing themselves owning this vehicle. Have a list of questions prepared that you can ask. Ask them to expound on things they mentioned in the test drive.

If you let this time devolve into silence, the customer will be uncomfortable. You don't want them to feel uncomfortable or rushed. Icky feelings translate into lost opportunities. You want customers to return to the dealership for their future purchases, so don't give them an uncomfortable experience now.

EXAMPLE:

Sales: If this all works out today, what is the first trip you will be taking with your new car?

Customer: Probably just driving to work.

Sales: What about your days off? Where do you think might be the first place you will go? Maybe to the beach or the mountains?

Customer: Well, we are going to see some family down south.

Sales: Really? Where down south?

Customer: Down in the Newport area.

Sales: Ahh, yes! Those are some of the best beaches anywhere! Where do you guys like to eat there? (Etc....)

The goal is to make them comfortable during a tense time. Help them visualize themselves in the new vehicle so that they can take mental ownership. You are changing this from a tense time to a happy time.

If you can time these 3 conversations and stay on track, your transaction will go a lot smoother. It will be more profitable, and you'll end up with a much happier customer. **You control the vibe in the room at all times.**



Notes:

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Role Play

Role playing helps your new salespeople get so comfortable with the steps that they will sound more natural to customers. It will give them confidence that they can handle ANY scenario.

Steps one through three happen pretty quickly. Role playing helps new salespeople recognize the opportunities and signposts within each step of the process. The more comfortable salespeople are with the process, the easier they can eliminate objections.

STEP TWO:

Power Meet & Greet

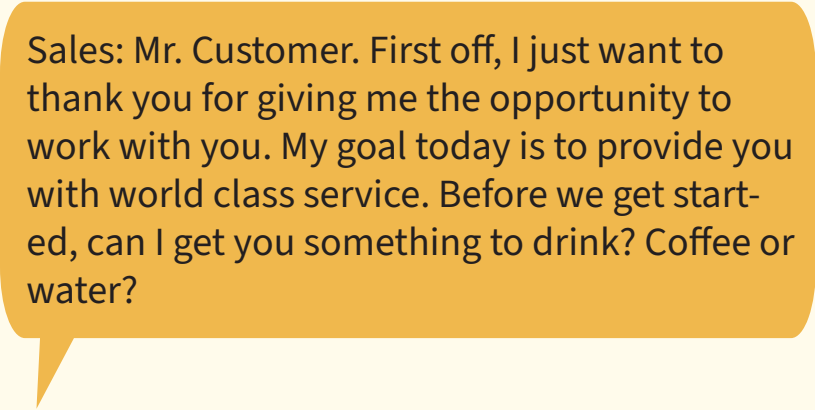
Be ready when the customer pulls up (STEP ONE). Be attentive, smile, and have an attitude of service.

Don't let the customer walk around and look at vehicles on their own. You are not pushy if you greet the customer right away. The customer either views you as lazy for not greeting them, or they might think that you have sized them up and decided they can't buy a car. You set the vibe, don't give the customer a chance to default to negative impressions.

Introduce yourself to everyone present, don't leave anyone out.

We establish authority and stand out from competitors. This is an unspoken commitment to the customer, a very important one.

EXAMPLE:



Sales: Mr. Customer. First off, I just want to thank you for giving me the opportunity to work with you. My goal today is to provide you with world class service. Before we get started, can I get you something to drink? Coffee or water?

This is likely something they never heard before. This puts you in a class by yourself, above other salesmen they have dealt with. If they recently came from another dealer, this makes sure that you don't sound anything like the last dealer. This takes practice, but trust me when I tell you that this makes a HUGE difference.

STEP THREE:

Investigate

Before you land on a vehicle, you need to know:

- who it's for
- wants
- needs
- leverage
- budget

80% of more of today's customers already have a vehicle in mind before they step onto the lot. This limits your time to investigate before getting to the vehicle, so don't waste time talking about nonsense. Get straight to the questions.

EXAMPLE, MOST COMMON CUSTOMER (80%):

Sales: (Immediately after meet & greet) So, do you guys want to see something new or pre-owned?

Customer: Where are your used cars?

Sales: Right this way. Do you want to see everything we have or did you have something specific in mind?

Customer: (80% of the time) We saw that you had XYZ car. Do you still have that?

Sales: Yes, I do. Come with me. By the way, who is the lucky one getting the car?

Customer: It's for me.

Sales: Well, congratulations! (Big smile!) how long have you been thinking of getting a new car?

Customer: We have been looking for about a month now. (removing objections starts now.)

Sales: Ok, great. What is it about this one that jumped out to you? What made you decide on this one?

Customer: Well, it has 4WD, and it's the color I want. I tried to get a new one when they first came out. (wants & needs)

This is where you have to listen carefully.

They will give you their wants and needs, and tell stories. You have to listen and pick up the clues as they come.

Sales: Perfect. It sounds like you found the right car. If this all works out today, what type of monthly budget did you have in mind?

Customer: We are thinking somewhere around \$500 a month.

If you are within \$100 of where you should be on payment, just move forward. That's not a hard bump. If you are miles off, this is where you will offer something less expensive to get to their budget. In most cases they will turn it down, but it does get them to realize that their budget needs to change in order to get the car they want.

EXAMPLE, THE OTHER 20%:

This type of customer just started looking and are not sure what they want. This usually means that something has happened recently and they need a vehicle. The meet & greet, and discovering who the car is for are the same technique. The investigation of wants and needs will be a bit different.

Sales: So, what made you decide to start looking now?

Customer: Well, my car start slipping yesterday and I think my transmission is going out. (need)

Sales: Ahh, I see. Well let's start with what features your current car has that you want to keep for the next one.

Customer: Well, it has a leather interior and I like the way the back seat folds down for storage.

Sales: Ok. Perfect. And what is it missing that you would like on the next one? (wants)

Customer: I'd like better fuel mileage, and if possible, maybe tinted windows.

Sales: Perfect. If we find the perfect vehicle, what type of monthly budget did you have in mind?

Customer: Somewhere around \$500

Sales: I have the perfect one for you. Come with me.

With this type of customer, you need to be building a vehicle in your mind as you collect the data. Make a suggestion. If they decline the vehicle that you showed them, don't just show more. Step back and find out what is missing so that you can show them the right thing.

WALK AROUND WITH VALUE

6 points to a walk around:

1. Style
2. Safety
3. Comfort & convenience
4. Economy
5. Utility
6. Performance

You need to have a basic idea about these points on a vehicle, but you won't go over all of them. Today's customer has a very short attention span. If you ramble on about things that are not important to the customer, you can lose them in just a couple of minutes.

BEFORE you start your walk around, step back and ask the customer what is important to him in this vehicle. If they need help answering that, then toss one or two examples to them: Is safety important to you? How about performance?

Go over just a couple of features. This should take from 3 to 5 minutes, so make sure that they are interested in what you are saying.

There are only two ways to sell a car and make a customer feel good about their purchase. Price, or value.

Value is the best selling point. We separate ourselves by selling value.

Perception IS reality. Selling value is how we separate our store from the rest.

EXAMPLE OF SEPARATING YOUR DEALERSHIP FROM THE COMPETITION~USED CAR POLICY:

Sales: Mr. Customer, let me tell you why more people in this area buy their used cars right here. (social confirmation). You see that shop there? Every one of our used cars go through that shop for a 120 point inspection. Whatever needs fixed, replaced, or repaired is done before we bring it to the lot. The crazy thing is only about half of what we put in actually pass our inspections. The ones that don't get sent back to the auction and often times will end up on other lots for cheaper. We make sure that you get what you pay for when you buy a car from us. Let me go get the key, I'll be right back.

KEY TAKEAWAY:

What you've done is establish value over price. Later in the process, if the customer says he saw it cheaper at another dealership, you can counter back that if he bought a cheaper car that had nothing but problems, he wouldn't want to go back to that dealership. We make sure of the quality so that customers want to come back to us. Value over price.

EXAMPLE OF SEPARATING YOUR DEALERSHIP FROM THE COMPETITION~NEW CAR POLICY:

Sales: Mr. Customer, let me tell you why we sell so many new cars here. We have the lowest mark ups in the area and we take care of our customers after the sale. If you ever have a concern or just need help with a service appointment, just give me a call. I give my cell phone number to my customers. You can contact me directly and I'll take care of it. We also pay more for our trades back when you are ready to upgrade. (value over price)

KEY TAKEAWAYS:

Most customers today know what they want and have researched the vehicle for 2 weeks.

In most cases, that means you need to focus on separating your self and your store from the others by your world class customer service and focusing on the value you provide them.

Confirm that they picked the right car. Confirm the things they already like on the car.



Notes:

[illegible]

TURNING: HOW, WHEN & WHY

When to turn your deal over to another salesman:

- If you are having a personality clash
- If you have no control of the sale
- If you're not sure you have a deal **right now**
- Even if the customer says he'll be back to-night with his wife, etc

Turn your deal as soon as you think you don't have a deal. Don't wait. It happens to all of us. It's better to make half a deal than no deal.

KEY TAKEAWAYS:

Less is more. When you turn a deal, just keep it simple. Give the new salesman the name of the person the vehicle is for. Even if the salesman asks for more information, don't give it. You don't want to influence his thinking, you want him to go in open minded. Resist the desire to give your opinion here, it will give the deal the best chance.

Turning can give the customer a fresh chance to save face. Sometimes customers lie, and then don't have a way to save face. For example, maybe the customer says he can't buy today (in order to protect himself), and now things are going good, but he doesn't know how to tell you that he wasn't telling the truth earlier. Turning gives him a way out. This is exactly why less is more when you give the information to the new salesman. Give the customer a chance to give new answers. Let the new salesman start over.



Notes:

[illegible]

BASIC OUTSIDE OBJECTIONS

Basic outside objections:

- Just looking
- Need my wife, need to think, need to delay
- Any money objection
- Don't need to drive it

Our only goals for outside is to land, test drive, and GET INSIDE. Outside is for pushing the deal forward, period.

EXAMPLE FOR “JUST LOOKING”:

Customer: Hi, we are just looking, we are not ready to buy anything today.

Sales: Great, do you want to look at something new or preowned?

Notes:

EXAMPLE FOR “NEED TO DELAY”:

Customer: I need my wife to come back and look with me **OR** I need time to think, I don't make decisions at the dealership **OR** I need to look at a car at another dealership that I have an appointment with.

Sales: Not a problem! While you are here, let me get you everything you need to make a decision when you are ready. Come with me.
(INSIDE)

Notes:

EXAMPLE FOR ANY MONEY OBJECTION:

Customer: Hi, we are just wanting to know what your best price is on this car? OR What is your rate? OR What will you give us for our trade?

Sales: I know price is important to you.
BEFORE WE PART not only will I get you the best price, I'll find your best payment and best rate as well. First, let's drive it and make sure it's the right car. As soon as we get back, I'll get you all that information. Fair enough?

Notes:

EXAMPLE FOR “DON’T NEED TO DRIVE IT”:

Customer: We don’t need to drive it. We are in a bit of a rush to get to an appointment.

Sales: Wouldn’t you agree that ride quality, comfort, and performance are important in this decision? Perfect. Let’s just take it around the block and make sure it checks all

Notes:

HABITS FOR SUCCESS

TEN ESSENTIAL HABITS:

1. Attitude
2. Get what you want
3. Set goals
4. Stop complaining
5. Solution thinking
6. Don't gossip
7. Chasing money
8. Not my job
9. Appearance
10. Win or learn

Winning starts with great habits. As you go over the habits listed in the next few pages, do an honest assessment of your habits. Starting a new job opportunity is a great motivation for improving the habits that will help you succeed.

How is your attitude? Attitude is something you can control. There is a positive and negative in every situation. It's up to you how you want to view it.

Help people get what they want. If you help enough people get what they want, you'll get what you want in return. Generosity is a rare and valuable trait that will make you stand out from other salesmen.

Set goals. Set audacious goals. Short term and long term goals are great tools to help your purpose and motivation.

Stop complaining. Nobody likes whiners and whining never solved anything. Teddy Roosevelt said: "Talking about a problem without proposing a solution is called whining."

Winners are solution thinkers. Be the valuable person that finds a way. Customers love it, co-workers love it. Everyone loves a person who can get 'er done.

Don't gossip. Ever. “Loose lips sink ships” goes the old saying. Nothing good ever comes from gossip. This is a fast way to lose respect.

Don't chase money. When your focus is on winning and helping others, the money will follow. Chasing money alone will cause people not to trust you.

Don't say, even to yourself, “it's not my job.” This poor attitude will come off as you being lazy and not a team player.

How is your appearance? Take pride in the way you look. People judge your competency level, your confidence, and your work ethic just by the way you look and the way you carry yourself.

Win or learn. Failing is a part of learning. There are no failures, just lessons. Review what happened and make adjustments so that you can continue to improve. Take the long view to keep your motivation up. Each lesson sets you up for future success.

TRAINING CHECKLIST

On the following pages, find a sample training checklist to compliment the training schedule provided in the first chapter.

File the completed checklist in the employee's file.

Memorize 10 Steps

-   Step 1 Attitude
-   Step 2 Meet & Greet
-   Step 3 Investigate
-   Step 4 Walk & Choose
-   Step 5 Display (sell the vehicle)
-   Step 6 Walk Around (sell the store)
-   Step 7 Demo/drive the car
-   Step 8 Communicate (build rapport)
-   Step 9 Commit to coming inside
-   Step 10 Write up & close
-   After Sale: Deliver unit, social media pictures and reviews

Three Conversations

- ☐ ☐ Role play: Steps 2 & 3
- ☐ ☐ Role play: walk around with value
- ☐ ☐ Separate your store from others
- ☐ ☐ How, when, and why to turn
- ☐ ☐ Role play the write up
- ☐ ☐ How to use the CRM
- ☐ ☐ How to use V Auto or Used Car Tool
(used car process)
- ☐ ☐ Learn basics of new car inventory
- ☐ ☐ How to stock in trades
- ☐ ☐ Basic outside objections
- ☐ ☐ How to create Facebook/social media
ads
- ☐ ☐ Role play going from A to Z
- ☐ ☐ You agree that you understand the
training materials, and are comfort-
able with everything you have learned. You are
ready to sell. You will hold yourself accountable
to work and perform to the standards that you
have learned in this training.

About the Author

Curtis Riggleman is a successful Director of Operations who currently manages several dealerships in Central California. He came from a background of poverty. Through determination and a winning attitude, he made his way to the top of his field. His passion is to empower new salesmen and sales managers to confidently engage customers and level up their income.



Level Up:

Check out the other books in the series

1. Objections Aren't Real

2. Leaders, Not Managers

3. Closing 101

4. Five Days You'll Never Get Back
(On Boarding)



Notes:

[illegible]

SET YOUR SALESPeOPLE UP TO SUCCEED:

When salespeople are properly trained, they have a much better chance of succeeding in their first 3 months of employment. This effectiveness is crucial to a thriving dealership. Say goodbye to high employee turnover.

PRIOR PROPER PREPARATION=SALES:

- Use this book to train new salespeople.
- Learn how to set up a training schedule to optimize your training hours.



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